Weekly Paper Digest

Generated: 2026-09-30 13:41 Period: 2026-09-15 to 2026-09-29

Total: 30 papers (28 with abstract, 30 with PDF)

Contents

1 Strategy **2**

1.1 Strategic Management Journal . . . 2

1.1.1 1. Designing for unanticipated uses: How product attributes shape community-led exaptation . . . 2

1.1.2 2. Platform development in incumbent firms: The interplay of data and actor interests in adding platforms to existing businesses . . . 2

1.1.3 3. Accommodation in the vertical supply chain: Implications of manufacturer dual tracking . . . 3

1.1.4 4. From accidents to assets—The value pathways of patents for serendipitous inventions . . . 4

1.1.5 5. Does innovation success need advocacy? Stakeholder involvement in firm innovation . . . 4

1.1.6 6. Drifting to the top? The effects of category erraticism on status mobility in the U.S. venture capital industry . . . 5

1.1.7 7. Firm divisionalization and the gender gap in CEO promotion . . . 6

1.2 Academy of Management Journal . . . 7

1.2.1 1. Ambiguity as Opportunity: A Theoretical Model of Conspiracy Entrepreneurship 7

1.3 Administrative Science Quarterly . . . 7

1.3.1 1. "Clean" Meat? Regulatory Entrepreneurship and Jurisdictional Contestation in a Nascent Industry . . . 7

1.3.2 2. Book Review: Ilana Redstone. The Certainty Trap: Why We Need to Question Ourselves More—and How We Can Judge Others Less . . . 8

1.4 Academy of Management Review . . . 9

1.4.1 1. Vibe Managers, Gurus, and Rockstars: Decoding the Strategic Use of Unconventional Job Titles in Organizations . . . 9

1.4.2 2. Facing Strong Currents...But with an Even Stronger Crew . . . 9

1.5 Organization Science . . . 9

1.5.1 1. What Drives Chief Executive Officer Activism and What Chief Executive Officer Activism Drives: Why Chief Executive Officers Speak Out, When Firms Translate Activist Stances into Action, and How Chief Executive Officer Activism Builds Social Momentum . . . 9

1.5.2 2. Can Task Motivation Backfire? The Roles of Perceived Task Interdependence and Interaction Avoidance . . . 10

1.5.3 3. Survival of the Flattest: Teams with Low (but Not High) Status Differentiation Turn Failure into Success by Adding High-Status Members . . . 11

1.5.4 4. Mixing Motives: Political Donations by Corporate Executives . . . 11

2 Innovation & Entrepreneurship **12**

2.1 Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice . . . 12

2.1.1 1. Appearance-Based Legitimate Distinctiveness: Founder Attractiveness, Gender, and Venture Evaluations . . . 12

2.1.2 2. First In, First Out? Birth Order and Next-Generation Engagement in Family Firms . . . 12

2.2 Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal . . . 13

2.2.1 1. Startup multihoming in enterprise software ecosystems: The role of skill breadth and organizational learning . . . 13
2.2.2 2. Temporal grammars of novelty: How carbon removal entrepreneurs frame new technologies . . . 13
2.2.3 3. Balancing coherence and resonance through linguistic framing: A longitudinal study of German biotechnology ventures' responses to the Covid-19 pandemic 14

3 General Management 15
3.1 Journal of Management Studies . . . 15
3.1.1 1. Between Play and Reason: Integrating Sensible Foolishness Into Strategy-Making Workshops . . . 15
3.1.2 2. Timeless: Karl Weick's Enduring Influence on Management Studies . . . 15
3.1.3 3. Heavy Time: Sensemaking and the Temporal Experience . . . 16
3.1.4 4. Is the Gene-ie Out of the Bottle? The Problems and Perils of Genetics Research in Management . . . 16
3.1.5 5. The Relational Dynamics of Multiparty Alliances: An Interdependence-Based View . . . 17
3.1.6 6. What Future for Genetics in Management Research? . . . 17
3.2 Journal of Management . . . 18
3.2.1 1. Passing on Talent: A Generativity Perspective on the Effects of Perceived Overqualification Among Older Employees . . . 18
3.2.2 2. Beyond Good and Bad: Understanding the Contradictory Effects of Positive Leadership Behavior and Negative Leadership Behavior . . . 18
3.3 Academy of Management Annals . . . 19
3.3.1 1. Toward a Framework of Social Marginalization: An Integrative Review and Research Agenda . . . 19

Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. Designing for unanticipated uses: How product attributes shape community-led exaptation

Authors: Shi-Ying Lim, Tian Heong Chan
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70132
Published: 2026-09-27

Keywords: exaptation, latent uses, modularity, product design, user innovation, visual simplicity

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, User Innovation, Design Research
- **Theories:** Exaptation, User Innovation Theory, Modularity Theory, Design Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Users often discover new uses for products that firms may later commercialize, which we call community-led exaptation. We examine how product attributes shape users' discovery of new func- tions versus new functionalities. Using 1925 IKEA product hacks, we find that modularity increases the likelihood of new functions. This effect strengthens when product components are compatible across prod- uct lines but weakens when esthetic product variants exist. Visual simplicity, conversely, increases the likeli- hood of new functionalities. These findings suggest that firms can structure the opportunity space for discovery through product design. Exploratory analysis of archi- val data and interviews further illustrates how IKEA re- sponds to these discoveries. We contribute to exapta- tion, user innovation, and design research by showing how product attributes shape the types of new uses communities discover. Managerial Summary: How can firms design prod- ucts to facilitate community-led exaptation? We find that product attributes can shape what users discover. Received: 26 September 2025 Revised: 18 August 2026 Accepted: 9 September 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70132 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–31. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Modular products enable users to find new functions (i.e., applications), while visually simple products enable users to find new functionalities (i.e., new prod- uct capabilities). Firms' decisions to offer components that are compatible across product lines and esthetic product variants can influence the likelihood of new functions. Additionally, firms can capitalize on these new uses by showcasing promising community- discovered functions on official channels or incorporate them as complements to existing product lines. How- ever, functional modifications can raise safety concerns and may require addi- tional development. Firms should therefore design for intended use, and for the kinds of new uses they are willing to seed and commercialize. K E Y W O R D S exaptation, latent uses, modularity, product design, user innovation, visual simplicity 1 |

 Lim - Designing for unanticipated uses How product attributes shape community-led exap.pdf

---

2. Platform development in incumbent firms: The interplay of data and actor interests in adding platforms to existing businesses

Authors: Jack Fraser, Elizabeth J. Altman, Pinar Ozcan
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70124
Published: 2026-09-24

Keywords: data bottlenecks, digital transformation, ecosystem governance, incumbent firms, platform development

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Platform Strategy, Digital Transformation, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Resource Dependency Theory, Absorptive Capacity, Process Theory, Power Dynamics

Abstract:

Research Summary: Despite growing interest in plat- form transitions, limited research examines how firms navigate challenges of building platform businesses alongside existing products. Through a longitudinal case study of a financial services firm launching a plat- form, we develop a process model revealing how data bottlenecks shape platform development. These bottle- necks arise from the interplay of technological limitations and control tensions over data aggregation, sharing, and usage. We identify five sequential bottlenecks, where resolving one reconfigures constraints, giving rise to the next. We theorize how data heterogeneity, variation in strategic sensitivity, and actors' absorptive capacity create opportunities for platform sponsors to capture value without competing with com- plementors. We extend resource dependency theory by showing how peripheral units overcome power imbal- ances by demonstrating value creation potential with limited data. Received: 21 July 2026 Revised: 21 July 2026 Accepted: 17 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70124 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–32. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: When established firms launch platforms alongside existing product businesses, they face significant data-related obstacles. Drawing on a four-year study of a financial services firm building a platform connecting SMEs with lenders, we show how firms must navigate challenges in collecting data from internal units and customers, making incompatible data sources work together, and persuading partners to share and use data in new ways. We find that these obstacles emerge in sequence, where resolving one cre- ates the conditions for the next. We also find that not all data is equally useful to all partners, and that these differences can open market segments the platform sponsor can serve without competing with its own part- ners. Managers can maintain momentum by combining short-term data workarounds with longer-term struc- tural solutions. K E Y W O R D S data bottlenecks, digital transformation, ecosystem governance, incumbent firms, platform development 1 |

 Fraser - Platform development in incumbent firms The interplay of data and actor interest.pdf

---

3. Accommodation in the vertical supply chain: Implications of manufacturer dual tracking

Authors: Young Hou
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70123
Published: 2026-09-22

Keywords: bargaining power, corporate strategy, imitation strategy, mergers, vertical relationship

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Supply Chain Management, Industrial Organization, Competitive Strategy
- **Theories:** Bargaining Theory, Vertical Relationships, Competitive Dynamics, Dual Tracking Mechanism

Abstract:

Research Summary: The prevalence of dual tracking, in which upstream manufacturers simultaneously produce branded and private-label products for down- stream retailers, has increased substantially in recent years, driven by growing consumer demand for private- label products. This paper examines the implications of manufacturer dual tracking by exploiting a setting in the ready-to-eat breakfast cereal industry where a lead- ing branded manufacturer began supplying both prod- ucts to retailers. We find that, because of this change in the vertical relationship, private-label product intro- ductions and advertising declined for products that directly imitated the dual-tracking manufacturer's branded products. Changes in retailer behavior suggest that retailers accommodated the dual-tracking manufacturer by selectively adjusting their private- label portfolios. Dual tracking can therefore improve a manufacturer's bargaining position against retailers and reduce downstream imitation. Managerial Summary: Manufacturers have increas- ingly produced not only their own branded products but also private-label products for retailers that com- pete with those brands. This phenomenon, known as dual tracking, carries benefits and risks for manufac- turers. While producing private-label products can Received: 1 June 2026 Revised: 20 August 2026 Accepted: 22 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70123 © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–

27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 utilize excess capacity, these products directly compete with the branded counterpart. We study the implica- tions for firms engaging in dual tracking and show that doing so gives manufacturers greater bargaining power in their relationships with retailers. Firms can leverage this change in bargaining power to reduce imitation by retailers' private-label products, lessen- ing competition concerns. Our results show that retailers reduced the introduction and advertising of private-label products that directly compete with the dual-tracking manufacturer. K E Y W O R D S bargaining power, corporate strategy, imitation strategy, mergers, vertical relationship 1 |

 Hou - Accommodation in the vertical supply chain Implications of manufacturer dual tra.pdf

---

4. From accidents to assets—The value pathways of patents for serendipitous inventions

Authors: Christoph Grimpe, Karin Hoisl, Myriam Mariani, Wolfgang Sofka
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70126
Published: 2026-09-21

Keywords: inventor survey, patent data, planned inventions, serendipitous patented inventions, value materialization pathways

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Intellectual Property Strategy, R&D Management
- **Theories:** Real Options Theory, Resource-Based View, Serendipity in Innovation, Complementary Assets

Abstract:

Research Summary: Firms often celebrate accidental inventions that lead to major breakthroughs, yet little is known about how the value of serendipitous inventions materializes. Using data from 8530 patented inventions across 23 countries, our research shows that these inventions differ from planned R&D outcomes. Seren- dipitous inventions are less likely to have a strong tech- nological impact, be turned into marketable products, or serve as effective blocking tools in patent strategy. However, they are more likely to generate value through licensing, indicating that while they may not fit the originating firm's strategy, they can succeed else- where. Hence, serendipitous patented inventions repre- sent "option-like" assets that offer external channels to capture value rather than relying on internal use. Managerial Summary: Accidental breakthroughs like microwaves, penicillin, or Velcro are often celebrated, Received: 29 October 2025 Revised: 24 August 2026 Accepted: 26 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70126 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–52. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 but their potential to create value in practice remains unclear. Analyzing data from 8530 patented inventions across 23 countries, we find that such serendipitous inventions differ fundamentally from planned R&D outcomes. They are less likely to yield major technolog- ical impacts, products, or strategic patents but more likely to generate value through licensing, functioning as "option-like" assets that are valuable externally more than internally. Thus, relative to planned inventions that benefit from downstream complementary assets, serendipitous patented inventions pay off more for firms with strong licensing or technology-selling capabilities. K E Y W O R D S inventor survey, patent data, planned inventions, serendipitous patented inventions, value materialization pathways 1 |

 Grimpe - From accidents to assets—The value pathways of patents for serendipitous inventi.pdf

---

5. Does innovation success need advocacy? Stakeholder involvement in firm innovation

Authors: Paolo Carioli, Christoph Grimpe, Karin Hoisl, Wolfgang Sofka
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70127

Published: 2026-09-18

Keywords: adoption of innovation, advocacy groups, audience evaluation, innovation collaboration, stakeholder theory

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Stakeholder Management, Innovation Management, Corporate Social Responsibility
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Signaling Theory, Legitimacy Theory, Collaborative Innovation

Abstract:

Research Summary: Prior research documents that firms often collaborate with advocacy groups to mitigate stakeholder contention. Integrating stakeholder theory into a performance model of collaborative innovation, we pro- pose an overlooked explanation for such collaborations: to enhance the adoption of firms' innovations. We argue that advocacy groups influence the adoption of innovations through a distinct, role-based legitimacy mechanism. Because advocacy groups are expected to scrutinize firms' conduct, their willingness to collaborate provides a credible signal that a firm's innovation is socially appropriate. These signals become particularly valuable when firms have pre- viously faced media criticism for socially irresponsible products or services and in industries characterized by high variation in corporate social performance. Using a Received: 25 June 2026 Revised: 25 June 2026 Accepted: 17 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70127 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–42. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 unique dataset on firms' innovation collaborations in Germany, we find support for our conjectures. Managerial Summary: Research indicates that firms collaborate with advocacy groups to avoid boycotts or protests. We introduce a largely overlooked additional rationale for such collaborations: to enhance the adoption of a firm's innovations. We suggest that advocacy groups can lend legitimacy to innovations and argue that firms benefit most from such collaborations when their prod- ucts and services received bad press in the past and when there is considerable variation in corporate social perfor- mance across firms in the industry. Based on unique data on innovation collaborations between firms and advocacy groups, we find that these conditions matter in determin- ing when firms can significantly benefit from involving advocacy groups in their innovation projects. K E Y W O R D S adoption of innovation, advocacy groups, audience evaluation, innovation collaboration, stakeholder theory 1 |

 Carioli - Does innovation success need advocacy Stakeholder involvement in firm innovation.pdf

---

6. Drifting to the top? The effects of category erraticism on status mobility in the U.S. venture capital industry

Authors: Danyang Li, Michael Jensen
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70130
Published: 2026-09-18

Keywords: categories, category erraticism, commitment, capability, status, mobility, venture capital

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Venture Capital, Organizational Sociology
- **Theories:** Category Theory, Status Mobility, Signaling Theory, Social Evaluation

Abstract:

Research Summary: We examine the effects of cate- gory erraticism, that is, having moved across socio-cognitively distant industry categories over time, on status mobility. We argue that it is not the breadth of the categories that a firm spans or the overall distance among those categories, but whether its movement across categories forms a coherent or incoherent tra- jectory, that hinders upward status mobility by creating commitment and capability concerns among external audiences. We further argue that these con- cerns are more problematic for higher status firms and more experienced firms because they are subjected to

stricter expectations of trajectory coherence. Using a comprehensive longitudinal sample of 1413 venture capital firms (VCs) in the U.S. VC industry from 1980 to 2012, we find that category erraticism reduces upward status mobility. This effect is partly mediated by the extent to which external audiences are con- cerned about the commitment and capability of the VCs, and is stronger for higher-status and more experienced VCs. Received: 12 March 2025 Revised: 8 June 2026 Accepted: 28 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70130 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–49. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: This study shows that how venture capital firms (VCs) move across industries over time shapes their status position in the VC industry. VCs that move across distant sectors in ways that appear incoherent, often described in the industry as thesis drift, strategy drift, or tourist VC behavior, raise concerns about their long-term commitment and ability to add value to the firms in which they invest. These concerns make it harder for such firms to form syndica- tion relationships with high-status partners, limiting their ability to improve their status position. In con- trast, VCs that expand across industries in a more con- sistent way, where moves build on prior experience and reflect a clear investment thesis, are more likely to be viewed as committed and capable, which facilitates upward status mobility. Using three decades of data on U.S. VC investments, we find that the downsides of erratic investment paths are especially pronounced for higher-status and more experienced VCs, which are held to stronger expectations of strategic coherence over time. K...

 Li - Drifting to the top The effects of category erraticism on status mobility in the.pdf

---

7. Firm divisionalization and the gender gap in CEO promotion

Authors: Tingyu Du, Ulya Tsolmon
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70128
Published: 2026-09-16

Keywords: CEO succession, executive advancement, gender inequality, internal promotion, managerial labor markets, organizational structure

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Corporate Governance, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Organizational Structure, Information Economics, Gender Inequality, Agency Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: This study examines how divisionalized firm structures shape the gender gap in internal chief executive officer (CEO) promotion. We argue that divisionalized firms may narrow the gender gap in CEO succession by generating more individually attributable performance information about senior managers. In contrast to firms in which candidates' contribu- tions are difficult to isolate, divisionalized firms create profit-and-loss (P&L) accountability that makes manage- rial performance more visible and comparable. Using longitudinal data on over 616,000 managers in 49,135 US firms, we find that women are more likely to be pro- moted to CEO in divisionalized firms. We also find that the gender gap is smaller among managers with prior P&L-accountable experience. Among managers in divisionalized firms, stronger unit performance relative to within-firm peers is more positively associated with promotion to CEO for women than for men. The results highlight organizational structure as a potential source of variation in gender inequality in executive advancement. Received: 24 March 2025 Revised: 19 August 2026 Accepted: 27 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70128 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–32. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: Why do so few women become CEOs? Part of the answer lies in how firms are organized. When a company is structured into divisions with their own profit-and-loss responsibility, the results of the managers who lead those units are easier to observe, compare, and credit to the individual. This leaves less room for subjective judgments through which gender bias often enters promotion decisions. In data on more than 600,000 managers at roughly 49,000 US firms, we find that women are more likely to be promoted to CEO in divisionalized firms. The pat- tern is strongest for women who have led a business unit, and strong unit results count for more in

women's promotion prospects. For boards seeking greater gender equity in CEO succession, structures and evaluation systems that give senior leaders clear, comparable per- formance records may matter as much as diversity initiatives. K E Y W O R D S CEO succession, executive advancement, gender inequality, internal promotion, managerial labor markets, organizational structure 1 |

 Du - Firm divisionalization and the gender gap in CEO promotion.pdf

---

Academy of Management Journal

1. Ambiguity as Opportunity: A Theoretical Model of Conspiracy Entrepreneurship

Authors: Sarah R. Chase, Sally Maitlis, Dean A. Shepherd
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2025.0640
Published: 2026-09-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Organizational Communication
- **Theories:** Sensemaking, Sensegiving, Opportunity Construction, Narrative Theory

Abstract:

We challenge the assumption that individuals strive to cope with ambiguity to move forward from it. Indeed, some sensegivers benefit from simultaneously facilitating and obstructing meaning-making to maintain people' s engagement in the sensemaking process. Specifically, we examine conspiracy entrepreneurship—constructing and exploiting a potential opportunity for commercial gain by crafting and disseminating a counternarrative to the official narrative of a negative public event while prolonging the audience' s sensemaking to preserve the opportunity over time. Through an inductive qualitative approach, we develop a theoretical model of conspiracy entrepreneurship. Our study, utilizing multimodal data sources, focuses on the 2022 Lafferty et al. v. Jones et al. court case, in which Alex Jones was sued by relatives of those killed in the Sandy Hook Elementary School shooting. We find that conspiracy entrepreneurship hinges on perpetuated sensegiving—a process whereby an actor continually introduces new cues and questions interpretations to shape and sustain others' efforts to make sense of an event and prevent narrative closure. We elucidate how entrepreneurs can mobilize stakeholders through identity-based engagement sustained by ambiguity rather than alignment around a clearly defined outcome, and offer insight into how ambiguity can become a source of influence for actors who lack formal authority yet shape others' sensemaking through communicative and socio-material practices.

 Chase - Ambiguity as Opportunity A Theoretical Model of Conspiracy Entrepreneurship.pdf

---

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. "Clean" Meat? Regulatory Entrepreneurship and Jurisdictional Contestation in a Nascent Industry

Authors: Cheng Gao, Alicia DeSantola, Nina Guilbeault
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261477694
Published: 2026-09-28

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Non-market Strategy, Innovation Ecosystems
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Regulatory Entrepreneurship, Jurisdictional Contestation, Stakeholder Theory

Abstract:

In nascent industries, uncertainty about which regulatory agency has jurisdiction is often a major challenge for pioneering ventures. Yet, much of the literature on new ventures' nonmarket strategy takes for granted the existence of a designated regulator. How do ventures manage regulatory jurisdictional uncertainty? We

conduct an inductive, multi-case research study on how entrepreneurial organizations pioneering the nascent cell-cultivated-meat industry navigated such uncertainty in the United States between 2015 and 2019. Drawing on extensive semi-structured interviews and archival data, we uncover stratagems and processes that organizations employ across three phases of regulatory jurisdictional uncertainty: jurisdictional void, contestation, and convergence. Our resulting theoretical framework distinguishes two overarching strategies —complementary and oppositional—and unpacks their underlying mechanisms, theorizing how they enable organizations to influence jurisdictional uncertainty. Our study uniquely elucidates the rich dynamics among the disparate actors that compose nascent technology-enabled industries: new ventures, nonprofits, incumbents, investors, and regulators. More broadly, it provides a fresh perspective on how entrepreneurial organizations shape the regulatory architecture of the industries they are striving to create.

 Gao - "Clean" Meat Regulatory Entrepreneurship and Jurisdictional Contestation in a Na.pdf

---

2. Book Review: Ilana Redstone. The Certainty Trap: Why We Need to Question Ourselves More —and How We Can Judge Others Less

Authors: Rellie Derfler-Rozin
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261488839
Published: 2026-09-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Conflict Resolution, Social Psychology, Management Education
- **Theories:** Moral Foundations Theory, Uncertainty Management, Perspective-taking, Civic Discourse

Abstract:

To state that we live in troubled and deeply polarized times in the United States and other countries has become almost a cliché.The underlying conditions that give rise to this observation remain pressing: Political and social discourse increasingly oscillates between extremes, hate crimes are on the rise (Farrell & Lockwood, 2023), and trust in institutions (Brady & Kent, 2022), including educational institutions, has eroded over time. 1 As a scholar who has researched and taught negotiation and conflict resolution for more than a decade, I found this book to be particularly timely.Research on dialogue and conflict resolution has largely emphasized the importance of civic discourse (e.g., Weaver et al., 2023), perspective-taking (e.g., Longmire & Harrison, 2018), and understanding the moral foundations underlying political disagreement (Graham et al., 2013).Several of these approaches, particularly Moral Foundations Theory and the emphasis on moral humility, intersect with arguments advanced in Redstone's book.At the same time, the book departs in important ways from dominant assumptions in the literature.Redstone contends that encouraging respectful discourse, while necessary, is insufficient for conflict resolution.Instead, she advocates engaging in deeper introspection, with particular emphasis on cultivating comfort with uncertainty.This emphasis on uncertainty represents a notable departure from scholarship on the motivation for resolving and reducing uncertainty (e.g., FeldmanHall & Shenhav, 2019).Redstone's argument is compelling: The contexts in which uncertainty feels most intolerable-discussions of highly charged social and political issues-are precisely those in which embracing uncertainty is most essential.A related departure from existing research is her claim that combating misinformation and disinformation, while important, should not be the primary focus of efforts to reduce polarization.Instead, she suggests that learning to live with uncertainty addresses the deeper source of the problem and may, as a secondary effect, enhance individuals' ability to evaluate and discern information.Redstone uses examples from both the political right and left, coupled with her insistence that no group holds moral superiority.She emphasizes the shared responsibility of recognizing the certainty trap and taking steps to avoid it.Redstone articulates the certainty trap through three interrelated fallacies: the settled question fallacy, the fallacy of equal knowledge, and the fallacy of known intent.The settled question fallacy refers to the tendency to treat complex issues as though they have already been conclusively resolved.Resisting this fallacy requires the ability to ask questions openly without being demonized (p.11).Importantly, Redstone emphasizes that rejecting the settled question fallacy does notBook Review 1488839A

 Business - Book Review Ilana Redstone. The Certainty Trap Why We Need to Question Ourselves.pdf

---

Academy of Management Review

1. Vibe Managers, Gurus, and Rockstars: Decoding the Strategic Use of Unconventional Job Titles in Organizations

Authors: Elizabeth H. Eley
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0311
Published: 2026-09-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Human Resource Management, Organizational Theory, Recruitment and Selection
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Categorization Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Job titles communicate occupational role and status in a form readily understood within and across organizations. However, popularization of a new class of job titles challenges the extant theoretical understanding of job titles as standardized categorization tools. Titles such as "chief storyteller" or "happiness hero" raise questions about why organizations would assign such titles. In this paper, I take a strategic human resource management perspective and develop theory to explain how organizations use unconventional job titles to signal: (a) the re-bundling of new tasks into novel roles, and (b) the rebranding of a role to reflect the organization's symbolic attributes. Drawing on these two signals, I differentiate four types of titles: "conventional," "elastic," "semantic," and "transfigured." I then link these job title types to both intended and unintended outcomes in the hiring process. I identify two downstream signal cost mechanisms—(1) legibility costs at attraction and (2) verification costs at selection—that reveal the costs organizations bear when they deploy signals outside established institutional infrastructure. As a whole, I seek to revitalize dormant theory on job titles and offer a timely lens into how titles function as some of the first signals of a broader human resource management system in a dynamic labor market environment.

 Eley - Vibe Managers, Gurus, and Rockstars Decoding the Strategic Use of Unconventional.p

---

2. Facing Strong Currents…But with an Even Stronger Crew

Authors: Kris Byron
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2026.1082
Published: 2026-09-15

Abstract not available. Byron - Facing Strong Currents…But with an Even Stronger Crew.pdf

---

Organization Science

1. What Drives Chief Executive Officer Activism and What Chief Executive Officer Activism Drives: Why Chief Executive Officers Speak Out, When Firms Translate Activist Stances into Action, and How Chief Executive Officer Activism Builds Social Momentum

Authors: Ghina Chammas
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2026.23114
Published: 2026-09-23

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Governance, Corporate Social Responsibility
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Institutional Theory, Social Movement Theory, Social Evaluation Theory

Abstract:

Chief executive officer (CEO) activism—CEOs' personal and public expression of a stance on a sociopolitical debate aimed at influencing opinions in the espoused direction—is often understood as stemming primarily from CEOs' political ideology and studied through its effects on distinct audiences, such as employees, consumers, and investors. Building on CEO activism research and integrating insights from upper echelons theory, institutional theory, nonmarket strategy, social movements, psychology, and social evaluations, this dissertation unpacks what remains less clear on both sides of this definition. On the "personal expression" side, it introduces CEO narcissism as a complementary explanation given its prevalence among CEOs, link to attention seeking, and relevance to a visible act like CEO activism. On the "public influence" side, it examines consequences beyond isolated audience reactions: whether public stances are followed by firm sustainability-related initiatives and how CEO activism travels through several actors whose interactions can generate social momentum and raise issue salience for policymakers. Across three essays, issue characteristics emerge as central to understanding why CEOs choose particular topics and what follows once they do. The issues that CEOs choose shape the attention that a CEO's stance attracts, the conditions for firm follow-through, and the likelihood that a stance travels into public and political debate. Taken together, the essays show that issues most likely to draw attention to CEOs may be least likely to generate firm follow-through yet still matter for public and political debate. Funding: This work was supported by funding from the French National Research Agency (Agence Nationale de la Recherche) under the Investissements d'Avenir programme [Grant ANR-18-EURE-0005 / EUR DATA EFM].

Chammas - What Drives Chief Executive Officer Activism and What Chief Executive Officer Ac.pdf

---

2. Can Task Motivation Backfire? The Roles of Perceived Task Interdependence and Interaction Avoidance

Authors: Dan Ni, Hansen Zhou, Xin Qin, Jie Zhong, Xiaoming Zheng
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.18802
Published: 2026-09-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Work Psychology, Task Motivation
- **Theories:** Motivated Information Processing Theory, Interpersonal Perspective

Abstract:

The extant literature on task motivation has generally demonstrated its beneficial effects on workplace outcomes. Although some evidence has raised concerns about the potential link between task motivation and maladaptive behaviors, this line of work has been grounded in an intrapersonal perspective that focuses on employees' internal regulation. Guided by motivated information processing theory, we adopt an interpersonal perspective to examine how task motivation may, under certain conditions, lead to interaction avoidance, a maladaptive workplace behavior with downstream implications for job performance. We theorize that, when perceiving a lower level of task interdependence, employees with higher task motivation are more likely to engage in interaction avoidance. This avoidance, in turn, is negatively related to job performance. Across an online experiment with a U.S. sample, a field experiment with a Chinese sample, and a survey with a Chinese sample, our hypotheses are supported. This research builds a more balanced understanding of how task motivation influences employee behavior and performance. In practice, managers should actively channel the effort of highly task-motivated employees to ensure their motivation translates into effectiveness rather than counterproductive avoidance. Funding: This work was supported by the National Natural Science Foundation of China [Grants 72202248 (D. Ni); 71872190, 72272155, and 72325012 (X. Qin); and 72172074 (X. Zheng)]. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18802 .

Ni - Can Task Motivation Backfire The Roles of Perceived Task Interdependence and Int.pdf

---

3. Survival of the Flattest: Teams with Low (but Not High) Status Differentiation Turn Failure into Success by Adding High-Status Members

Authors: Yufei Zhong, Huisi (Jessica) Li, Xirong (Subrina) Shen, Nicholas A. Hays, Jizhen Li
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19306
Published: 2026-09-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Team Dynamics, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Teams-as-Open-Systems Perspective, Status Hierarchy Research, Social Hierarchy

Abstract:

Most prior research on teams' responses to failure treats teams as closed systems. However, after failures, teams may seek to improve performance by bringing in new members. Adopting a teams-as-open-systems perspective, we test which teams are more willing to add high-status members following failures and whether doing so improves team performance. Drawing on status hierarchy research, we posit that after a team failure, members will feel uncertain about their own status (particularly those with high status). More importantly, we predict that the impact of this status uncertainty on members' willingness to add high-status new members depends on teams' preexisting status differentiation. Specifically, status uncertainty leads members in low-status-differentiation teams to perceive adding a high-status new member as a potential benefit to collective performance, whereas it leads members in high-status-differentiation teams to perceive the addition as a potential threat to their own status. We theorize that these individual perceptions shape teams' collective decisions through an emergent process. Taken together, we predict that at the team level, failure will increase the willingness to add high-status members in teams with low but not high status differentiation and that such addition improves subsequent team performance. Using longitudinal archival data on product development teams (Study 1, n = 4,811 teams) and two preregistered experiments at the individual (Study 2, n = 783 participants) and team levels (Study 3, n = 222 teams), we found support for these predictions. This research advances the literature on team failure and illuminates dynamics between membership change and social hierarchy. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19306 .

 Zhong - Survival of the Flattest Teams with Low (but Not High) Status Differentiation Tu.pdf

---

4. Mixing Motives: Political Donations by Corporate Executives

Authors: Benjamin Barber, Daniel J. Blake
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19531
Published: 2026-09-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Political Activity, Strategic Management, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Resource Dependence Theory, Strategic and Expressive Motivation

Abstract:

What motivates corporate executives to make political donations? Scholars interested in political ideology generally assign expressive motivations to executive donations, whereas corporate political activity scholars view executives as largely strategic donors. This study reconciles these two contrasting perspectives by reconceptualizing executives as mixed-motive donors who allocate their donations both strategically and expressively. To support this position, we construct the most comprehensive data set to date on executive donations from 1980 to 2024 and develop a measure of mixed-motive donations that reflects both expressive and strategic giving. Using nonexecutive donors as a counterfactual baseline of expressive donors, we provide evidence that bipartisan donations and donations to politically influential members of Congress are examples of strategic giving. We find that executives devote a larger share of their donations to strategic giving driven by their role as executives. This supports the argument, rooted in resource dependence theory, that executives face professional incentives to donate strategically. However, we also find evidence that a nontrivial portion of executives' donations are expressive and that strategic giving varies across individuals and time. We find that variance in mixed-motive giving can be explained partly by executives' compensation

elasticity, firm size, political risk exposure, and whether an executive is the CEO of the company. Overall, our analysis reveals that scholars should refrain from making uniform assumptions about executives' motivations to donate and view them as a varied group of mixed-motive donors. Funding: This work was supported by the Government of Spain's Agencia Estatal de Investigación [Grant PID2022-138747NB-I00]. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19531 .

 Barber - Mixing Motives Political Donations by Corporate Executives.pdf

---

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Appearance-Based Legitimate Distinctiveness: Founder Attractiveness, Gender, and Venture Evaluations

Authors: Henrik Lekkas, Torben Antretter, Ivo Blohm, Charlotta Sirén, Joakim Wincent
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261485961
Published: 2026-09-28

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Social Psychology, Gender in Management
- **Theories:** Optimal Distinctiveness Theory, Role Congruity Theory, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

This study proposes a way to reconcile the beauty premium and beauty-is-beastly arguments by suggesting that founder appearance is processed through two separable and countervailing channels: perceived legitimacy and perceived distinctiveness. We further theorize that in start- ups, the relationship is gendered, because women do not fit the entrepreneurial prototype, lim- iting their perceived legitimacy. A field study of 359 founders supports our theorizing that male founders are evaluated best when moderately attractive, while female founders see no signifi- cant attractiveness effects. A preregistered experiment with 771 participants, using AI-manipu- lated attractiveness, does not confirm these patterns but supports our theorizing about both mediators.

 Lekkas - Appearance-Based Legitimate Distinctiveness Founder Attractiveness, Gender, and.pdf

---

2. First In, First Out? Birth Order and Next-Generation Engagement in Family Firms

Authors: Mohamed Genedy, Lucia Naldi, Karin Hellerstedt
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261485870
Published: 2026-09-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Family Business, Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Birth Order Theory, Family Systems Theory, Career Choice Theory

Abstract:

Research shows that next-generation engagement in the family business is important for the busi- ness' s long-term survival. However, the literature has neglected how differences among children could explain their career choices in the family business. We address this gap by drawing on birth order theory to examine differences in three career choices of the next-generation: joining the family business, holding a managerial position, and leaving the family business. Using a sample from Sweden, we employ family-stratified hazard models and show that later-borns are more likely to join the family business as their initial career choice compared to earlier-born siblings. However, when the next-generation joins the family business, later-borns are less likely to hold managerial positions in the family business and more likely to leave the family business. We conduct several mechanism tests explaining our hypotheses and run additional robustness tests to

support our results. This study advances the research on next-generation engagement in family firms.

 Genedy - First In, First Out Birth Order and Next-Generation Engagement in Family Firms.pdf

---

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Startup multihoming in enterprise software ecosystems: The role of skill breadth and organizational learning

Authors: Vijayaraghavan Venkataraman, Marco Ceccagnoli, Chris Forman
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70048
Published: 2026-09-28

Keywords: enterprise software, learning, multihoming, platform ecosystems, skill breadth, startup

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Digital Platforms
- **Theories:** Organizational Learning, Resource-Based View, Path Dependency

Abstract:

Research Summary: We investigate startup decisions to multihome to another platform. We develop a theory that shows startup engagement with the initial platform leads first to exploratory learning and later a shift toward exploi- tation, leading to an inverted U-shape relationship between duration of platform partnership and the likelihood of mul- tihoming. This tradeoff is shaped by the breadth of the startup's skill base. Startups with a broader set of skills ini- tially face slower learning, but over time skill breadth pro- vides greater adaptability that better positions them for multihoming. We test our theory using a novel dataset on SAP partners' multihoming decisions, examining the implica- tions of Oracle acquisitions that increased the expected benefits of multihoming. Our empirical findings are consis- tent with our hypotheses. Managerial Summary: The growth phase forms an impor- tant part of any startup's evolution, particularly when engag- ing with digital platform ecosystems, where expansion often Received: 11 July 2026 Revised: 11 July 2026 Accepted: 31 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70048 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–26. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 depends on the ability to multihome. Startups' accumulated experience with a platform shapes how they respond when opportunities to expand to another platform arise. Startups with moderate levels of prior platform experience are most likely to expand, while longer relationships can create dependencies that reduce flexibility. Importantly, the breadth of a startup's skill base changes this trajectory. Startups with diverse skills are better able to avoid lock-in and remain flexible, even after long partnerships. Evidence from the enterprise software ecosystem shows managers should see platform partnerships as both opportunity and risk, investing in broad skill sets to balance deep collabora- tion with the ability to grow across platforms. K E Y W O R D S enterprise software, learning, multihoming, platform ecosystems, skill breadth, startup 1 |

 Venkataraman - Startup multihoming in enterprise software ecosystems The role of skill breadth.pdf

---

2. Temporal grammars of novelty: How carbon removal entrepreneurs frame new technologies

Authors: Ioana Sendroiu
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70034
Published: 2026-09-21

Keywords: carbon dioxide removal, novelty, temporality

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Sustainability Management, Strategic Communication
- **Theories:** Framing Theory, Mead's Philosophy of the Present, Sensegiving

Abstract:

Research Summary: This paper assesses the ways in which carbon dioxide removal ventures frame their work. Drawing on George Herbert Mead's philosophy of the present, it conceptualizes temporal grammars of novelty as a framing strategy that involves connecting two points in time, namely present and future, to elaborate novelty. Dictionary, depen- dency parsing, and large language model approaches trace the use of temporal grammars of novelty across the websites of carbon removal companies in the market, and connect this to venture sales volumes. Analyses show that ventures deploying newer technologies and using temporal grammars of novelty have higher sales. In contrast, explicitly causal language does not prove beneficial. This paper addresses a fundamental problem in conceptualizing novelty by arguing that it is referential without being causal, and shows this with reference to the framing strategies deployed by environmental entrepreneurs. Managerial Summary: Carbon removal entrepreneurs must convince buyers that novel, often unproven technologies are credible. This paper shows that how they talk about time matters. Analyzing website language and sales across carbon removal ventures, it finds that firms using more speculative technologies sell more when they link present action to Received: 31 January 2025 Revised: 21 April 2026 Accepted: 26 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70034 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–24. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 future possibility: what they are designing, building, or deploying now, and what this will make possible later, at scale. By contrast, causal language—detailed claims about why or how specific features will produce outcomes—is not helpful and is negatively associated with sales. When fram- ing novelty, pairing present action with future promise is more credible than over-specified causal certainty. K E Y W O R D S carbon dioxide removal, novelty, temporality 1 |

 Sendroiu - Temporal grammars of novelty How carbon removal entrepreneurs frame new technolo.pdf

---

3. Balancing coherence and resonance through linguistic framing: A longitudinal study of German biotechnology ventures' responses to the Covid-19 pandemic

Authors: Niklas Dreymann, Indre Maurer
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70045
Published: 2026-09-15

Keywords: exogenous shocks, flexibility, institutional logics, linguistic framing, new ventures, perseverance, qualitative methods

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Crisis Management
- **Theories:** Framing Theory, Signaling Theory, Sensegiving, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Research suggests that ventures bene- fit from framing to gain audience support, yet how they uti- lize framing when exogenous shocks redirect attention remains unclear. Drawing on a longitudinal multiple-case study of six biotechnology ventures following the COVID-19 pandemic, we show how ventures balance coherence and resonance through framing pathways. Perse- vering ventures, committed to pre-shock opportunities, maintained a "Blockbuster" framing, highlighting business viability to engage commercial investors. Flexible ventures, in contrast, adopted an "Emergency" framing, signaling responsiveness to societal threats to attract public investors, before transitioning to a "Preparedness" framing, emphasiz- ing long-term potential. Across both pathways, ventures anchored framings in a scientific perspective, signaling expertise and rigor. We theorize how ventures balance coherence and resonance through an anchoring frame that provides continuity and complementing frames that enable adaptation to shifting audience expectations. Received: 31 January 2025 Revised: 13 August 2026 Accepted: 17 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70045 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–31. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 Managerial Summary: Our study of six biotechnology ven- tures shows how

high-technology entrepreneurs communi- cate with investors during industry shocks, such as pandemics. We identify two distinct pathways. Ventures that pivot toward shock-related opportunities benefit from adopting an "Emergency" framing, positioning themselves as addressing urgent societal threats to attract public inves- tors. To sustain investor support over time, they subse- quently shift to a "Preparedness" framing, highlighting their solutions' long-term potential. Conversely, ventures that maintain their original strategies gain traction by consis- tently employing a "Blockbuster" framing, emphasizing their business case to attract commercial investors. Across both pathways, ventures reinforce credibility by anchoring their framings in scientific expertise, rigor, and the ability to address unmet medical needs. Pivoting ventures also leverage new applications to identify and capitalize on additional shock-related opportunities. K E Y W O R D S exogenous shocks, flexibility, institutional logics, linguistic framing, new ventures, perseverance, qualitative methods 1 |

 Dreymann - Balancing coherence and resonance through linguistic framing A longitudinal stud.pdf

---

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Between Play and Reason: Integrating Sensible Foolishness Into Strategy-Making Workshops

Authors: Rebecca Lu, Gary T. Burke, Omid Omidvar, David J. Carrington
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70167
Published: 2026-09-28

Keywords: atmosphere, play, process, sensible foolishness, sociomateriality, strategy-as-practice

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Strategy-as-Practice, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Strategy-as-Practice, Process Theory, Serious Play, Sensible Foolishness

Abstract:

Sensible foolishness through play can offer a valuable escape from prevailing dogmas and rational models of intelligence, affording actors freedom to explore, imagine, and create without constraint. Yet the value of sensible foolishness, and the vital interplay between play and reason, remains underexplored in strategy scholarship. Drawing on a qualitative experimental study of three SMEs, we examine how high-stakes strategic challenges can be addressed through sensible foolishness. Our analysis shows how the interplay between play and reason gains generative momentum during strategy-making workshops, as actors co-create playful atmospheres and shift into more expressive, embodied ways of being. We identify three transitional modes –deliberate , dialectical , and dwelling –through which actors integrate play and reason and co-produce moments of strategic insight and value. We develop a process theory of integrating sensible foolishness into strategy-making, showing how attuned facilitation and atmospheric shifts enable its enactment as a collective, affectively sustained mode of strategizing. This extends debates in strategy and serious play scholarship by advancing a practice-based view of sensible foolishness as a complementary instrument of collective strategic intelligence.

 Lu - Between Play and Reason Integrating Sensible Foolishness Into Strategy-Making Wo.pdf

---

2. Timeless: Karl Weick's Enduring Influence on Management Studies

Authors: Joep Cornelissen, Johann Fortwengel
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70162
Published: 2026-09-25

Keywords: organizations, sensemaking, theory, time, weick

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Management Studies, Sensemaking
- **Theories:** Sensemaking, Weickian Theory, Philosophy of Scholarship

Abstract:

The essay by Patriotta and Weick (2026) constitutes one of the last scholarly contributions by Karl Weick. In this Introduction, we position the essay vis-à-vis Weick's broader scholarship, and we outline how the ideas articulated in this piece complement theorizing on sensemaking. We also reflect on the more general influence of Weick on scholarship in management studies, including work published in JMS . We develop the argument that Weick's enduring legacy is not only confined to the introduction and articulation of some core and highly influential ideas to the field, but that his distinct ways of thinking, writing, and interpretation of what it means to be a scholar will have an at least equally lasting impact on present and future generations. In particular, in the age of artificial intelligence and the acceleration of academia, we propose that we have much to learn from Weick's mode of scholarship. In this sense, Weick's influence will be timeless and enduring; spanning concepts, the idea of having a distinct voice, and a model of scholarship.

 Cornelissen - Timeless Karl Weick's Enduring Influence on Management Studies.pdf

---

3. Heavy Time: Sensemaking and the Temporal Experience

Authors: Gerardo Patriotta, Karl E. Weick
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70163
Published: 2026-09-25

Abstract not available. Patriotta - Heavy Time Sensemaking and the Temporal Experience.pdf

---

4. Is the Gene-ie Out of the Bottle? The Problems and Perils of Genetics Research in Management

Authors: Jean Clarke, Joep Cornelissen, Mark P. Healey
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70164
Published: 2026-09-22

Keywords: behavioural genetics, genetics, phenomenon-driven research, reductionism

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Entrepreneurship, Research Methods
- **Theories:** Reductionism, Phenomenon-driven approach, Epistemology, Behavioral Genetics

Abstract:

In recent years, the field of management research has witnessed the emergence of a stream of research that seeks to identify the genetic determinants of managerial, entrepreneurial, and organizational behaviour. We challenge the reductionist epistemology underpinning this genetic perspective in management research and highlight the inherently weak inferences about human behaviour that follow from its prevailing methods and explanatory models. We further examine the ethical implications that arise from its underlying assumptions and potential future applications. We then propose recasting the role of genetics as part of a broader phenomenon-driven approach towards studying and explaining human behaviour in management research and outline a conceptual framework aimed at generating stronger and contextually grounded explanatory models of managerial, entrepreneurial, and organizational behaviour.

 Clarke - Is the Gene-ie Out of the Bottle The Problems and Perils of Genetics Research in.pdf

---

5. The Relational Dynamics of Multiparty Alliances: An Interdependence-Based View

Authors: Wenqian Wang, Jiabei Hu, Fabrice Lumineau
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70166
Published: 2026-09-21

Keywords: collaboration, interdependence, literature review, multiparty alliance, strategic alliance

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Inter-organizational Relationships, Alliance Management
- **Theories:** Interdependence-Based View, Relational Dynamics, Faultline Theory, Reciprocity

Abstract:

Despite the increasing relevance of multiparty alliances, existing research remains fragmented and predominantly organized around functional purposes or structural forms, overlooking the relational dynamics among alliance partners. Such an omission prevents a systematic understanding of what fundamentally distinguishes multiparty alliances from their dyadic counterparts and how different types of multiparty alliances vary from one another. This paper addresses this gap through a systematic review of research from leading management journals published between 1990 and 2025. Adopting an interdependence-based view, we offer two main insights. First, the presence of more than two partners introduces three categorically distinct features compared to dyadic alliances: a change in membership, a change in reciprocity patterns, and the emergence of faultlines. Each of these features poses distinct challenges. Second, and more importantly, we show how pooled, sequential, and reciprocal forms of interdependence shape the emergence, evolution, and consequences of these relational features, thereby explaining systematic variations across multiparty alliances. Building on these insights, we develop an integrative framework that clarifies the distinctiveness of multiparty alliances and identifies key mechanisms and boundary conditions. This framework informs a future research agenda to redirect scholarly attention to the unique relational dynamics within and across multiparty alliances.

 Wang - The Relational Dynamics of Multiparty Alliances An Interdependence-Based View.pdf

---

6. What Future for Genetics in Management Research?

Authors: Corinne Post
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70165
Published: 2026-09-17

Keywords: genetics, interdisciplinary, organizational behaviour

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Management Research Methodology, Interdisciplinary Research
- **Theories:** Evolutionary Theory, Causal Inference, Reductionism, Epistemology

Abstract:

The author teams on this Point-Counterpoint debate agree that the search for genetic explanations of organizational behaviours has been underwhelming –yet they have very different visions for the future of genetics in management research. The Point argues for a deeper dive into the field of genetics to ensure more precise measurement and make better causal inferences. In contrast, the Counterpoint cautions against reducing complex human behaviour to molecular causes and sees genetics as better suited to explain distal evolutionary conditions from which behaviours emerge. The introduction to this collection summarizes the core ideas in each article and their recommendations. The introduction then positions the Point-Counterpoint debate against the broader challenge of seeking to advance management research with knowledge from a different discipline. It concludes with a call for researchers to carefully consider when and under what conditions it is warranted to search for genetic explanations, rather than uncritically embracing genetic explanations or dismissing them outright.

 Post - What Future for Genetics in Management Research.pdf

Journal of Management

1. Passing on Talent: A Generativity Perspective on the Effects of Perceived Overqualification Among Older Employees

Authors: Jia Yu, Deshani B. Ganegoda, Chao Ma
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261480030
Published: 2026-09-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Human Resource Management, Aging and Work
- **Theories:** Generativity Theory, Prosocial Motivation

Abstract:

Drawing on generativity theory, we examine the positive effects of perceived overqualification among older employees. Specifically, we argue that perceptions of overqualification in older employees are positively associated with a core generativity motive—that is, a desire to support and guide the next generation and be needed by them. Further, we argue that generativity motive predicts prosocial attitudes and behaviors in the form of prosocial meaning of work for future generations and helping behavior. Additionally, we identify mature-age practices—that is, human resource practices tailored to address older employees' needs—as a key contextual factor that strengthens the indirect pathway between perceptions of overqualification in older employees and their prosocial attitudes and behaviors. We test and find support for our hypotheses in two inde pendent field studies—a three-wave field study of older employees (Study 1, N = 261) and a dyadic three-wave field study of employees of various ages and their respective supervisors (Study 2, N = 274 dyads). Theoretical and practical implications of our study are discussed. Acknowledgments: We sincerely thank our handling editor, Professor David Collings, and the two anonymous reviewers for their constructive feedback and thoughtful guidance throughout the review process. Their insightful comments and support have been invaluable in helping us strengthen the manuscript and bring it to its full potential. Chao Ma acknowledges funding from the Young Talent Support Plan of Xi' an Jiaotong University. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Chao Ma, Xi' an Jiaotong University, School of Management, Department of Organization Management, Wenguan Building, No. 28, Xianning West Road, Xi' an, Shaanxi 710049, P.R. China.

 Yu - Passing on Talent A Generativity Perspective on the Effects of Perceived Overqua.pdf

---

2. Beyond Good and Bad: Understanding the Contradictory Effects of Positive Leadership Behavior and Negative Leadership Behavior

Authors: Haoying (Howie) Xu, Xing Wang, Daan van Knippenberg
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261481739
Published: 2026-09-23

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Leadership Studies
- **Theories:** Leadership Contradictory Effects, Integrative Framework

Abstract:

Organizational scholarship has long focused on leadership behavior, largely assuming that "good" and "bad" leaders can be distinguished by distinct sets of behaviors that can be orga nized into constructs with an inherent positive or negative valence (e.g., transformational, ethi cal, abusive). This assumption has guided extensive construct development and generated a substantial body of evidence consistent with each leadership construct' s expected valence. Yet, emerging research has documented the "dark side" of positive leadership and the "bright side" of negative leadership, revealing effects that contradict these expectations —effects that we call leadership contradictory effects. Despite growing interest in this line of research, the literature remains fragmented, with limited clarity regarding its scope and little theoretical integration explaining why, how, and when such effects occur. This motivates our review, which synthesizes these fragmented findings into a cohesive theoretical account organized around shared themes that cut across leadership con-

structs. First, we define leadership contradictory effects and review major approaches to operationalize them. Then, we advance an integrative framework that delineates three major theoretical themes, their associated theories, and three categories of Acknowledgments: The authors are grateful to Dr. Orlando Richard, the Associate Editor, and the two anony mous reviewers for their thoughful guidance and constructive suggestions. We also thank Dr. John W. Lynch of the Department of Managerial Studies at the University of Illinois Chicago for his friendly review and valuable feedback on an earlier version of this manuscript. Finally, the first author acknowledges the support by the Photios Paulson ' 59 Endowed Fellowship from the School of Business at the Stevens Institute of Technology. Corresponding author: Haoying (Howie) Xu, School of Business, Stevens Institute of Technology, 1 Castle Point Terrace, Hoboken, NJ 07030, USA.

 Xu - Beyond Good and Bad Understanding the Contradictory Effects of Positive Leadersh.pdf

---

Academy of Management Annals

1. Toward a Framework of Social Marginalization: An Integrative Review and Research Agenda

Authors: McKenzie Preston, Y. Lillian Kim
DOI: 10.5465/annals.2025.0093
Published: 2026-09-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion, Sociology of Organizations
- **Theories:** Social Marginalization Framework, Symbolic and Material Disadvantage, Multilevel Dynamics

Abstract:

Despite a growing body of research on social marginalization in organizations, this scholarship remains fragmented across identity groups and disciplinary silos. As a result, organizational scholars lack a coherent framework to explain how marginalization persists and evolves across contexts. In this integrative review, we synthesize research from management, psychology, and sociology to develop a multilevel framework that conceptualizes marginalization as a recursive cycle between symbolic disadvantage (e.g., stereotyping, stigma, delegitimization) and material disadvantage (e.g., restricted access to jobs, resources, and institutional protections). We identify recurring mechanisms that operate across micro, meso, and macro levels, demonstrating how these dynamics mutually reinforce one another over time. Our framework also explains why interventions that target only one dimension of disadvantage often fall short or produce unintended consequences. We conclude by outlining a research agenda that advances theoretical development and empirical investigation of marginalization, including approaches to multilevel dynamics, temporal change, and measurement, as well as implications for designing more effective organizational interventions. Together, this integrative framework provides a unifying lens for understanding and addressing the cyclical dynamics of marginalization in organizations.

 Preston - Toward a Framework of Social Marginalization An Integrative Review and Research.pdf

---